several others involved in the plot were arrested in Havana in March 1966 and sentenced to 25 years in prison.[73]

In April 1964 Johnson called for an end to sabotage raids. Johnson was later quoted as complaining that "we had been operating a damned Murder, Inc., in the Caribbean."[74] Dean Rusk argued that sabotage had a "high noise level" and that it was too difficult to cover up U.S. involvement.[75] The last major CIA-organized raid of the Johnson era was in December 1963, when Cuban exiles mined Cuban waters near a naval base, blowing up a number of boats and killing and injuring several people.[76]

When CIA paramilitary operations were dismantled and shut down, the men the CIA had armed, funded and trained, and the arms the CIA had supplied, did not vanish overnight. "No one in Miami or Langley gave much thought to demobilizing the secret army of exiles," journalist David Corn explains. During the 1960s, 70s and 80s, the hand of these CIA-trained exiles turned up again and again in attacks on Cuba and Cubans, in paramilitary and terrorist attacks in the United States and elsewhere, in drug-running and laundering, in the Watergate burglaries, in the Contra War against Nicaragua, and in supposedly "humanitarian" organizations like Brothers to the Rescue.[77]

The cease and desist order did not apply to economic sabotage, which continued during the 1960s and 70s. The goal of the sabotage was clearly the same as it had been in the early 1960s: to discredit Cuba's experiments with socialism. "We wanted to keep bread out of the stores so people were hungry," a CIA officer assigned to anti-Castro operations told John Marks. "We wanted to keep rationing in effect and keep leather out, so people got only one pair of shoes every 18 months."[78]

The War Continues

The partial hiatus of the mid-1960s did not bring an end to covert actions against Cuba. According to Raymond Garthoff, "One of Nixon's first acts in office in 1969 was to direct the Central Intelligence Agency